

Part A: Parts of Speech

Identify the part of speech of the **bolded** word: noun, pronoun, verb, adjective, adverb, preposition, or conjunction.

1. The subway rattled **through** the tunnel. _____
2. Marisol answered the question **calmly**. _____
3. A sudden **storm** flooded the parking lot. _____
4. My aunt collects **antique** pocket watches. _____
5. The oven timer rang, **yet** nobody moved. _____
6. **We** biked to the reservoir on Saturday. _____
7. The goalie **dove** for the corner shot. _____
8. Theo guards his sketchbook **jealously**. _____
9. The bakery sits **near** the train station. _____
10. The lights flickered, **and** the movie stopped. _____
11. Two **restless** toddlers waited in line. _____
12. **Someone** borrowed my green umbrella. _____
13. Dad sharpened the kitchen **knife** on Sunday. _____
14. The earthquake **cracked** three windows downtown. _____
15. Fog rolled in **steadily** after sunset. _____
16. Leave the package **beside** the front door. _____
17. Nadia stayed home **because** her ankle hurt. _____
18. A **narrow** staircase led to the attic. _____
19. **Nothing** in the fridge looked edible. _____
20. Practice and patience **improve** almost any skill. _____

Part B: Subject and Predicate

For each sentence write (a) the complete subject, (b) the complete predicate, (c) the simple subject, and (d) the simple predicate.

1. The exhausted swimmer floated on her back.
2. Jonah and Priya shared a locker all year.
3. Down the driveway rolled an empty trash can.
4. The steady hum of the refrigerator annoyed everyone.
5. My brother's sprained wrist ached for weeks.
6. The careful electrician tested every outlet.
7. Behind the garage sat a broken lawnmower.
8. The referee paused the game and checked the clock.
9. The radio and the newspaper reported the same story.
10. A tall, quiet exchange student joined our class.

11. Under the porch hid a stray kitten.
12. The retired pilot trusted her own instincts.
13. Ines packed her lunch and caught the early bus.
14. The smell of fresh bread filled the hallway.
15. My grandfather's four acres of orchard needed constant care.

Part C: Subject–Verb Agreement

Circle the correct verb.

1. The carton of eggs (sit / sits) on the top shelf.
2. Each of the bicycles (was / were) repainted last spring.
3. Omar and Lucy (walks / walk) to school together.
4. Neither the players nor the coach (know / knows) the score.
5. There (is / are) four exits in this building.
6. The news from the hospital (worry / worries) my mother.
7. A row of tall hedges (block / blocks) the view.
8. Both of the puppies (need / needs) a bath.
9. Either Dana or her cousins (host / hosts) the party.
10. The scratches on the table (show / shows) its age.
11. Everybody in the choir (know / knows) the words.
12. Nine dollars (seem / seems) like a fair price.
13. Here (come / comes) the last two runners.
14. Most of the milk (taste / tastes) sour.
15. Curiosity and hard work (make / makes) a good scientist.

Each sentence below has one agreement error. Rewrite it correctly.

16. The stack of towels were still damp.
17. Neither Ravi nor Celia remember the address.
18. There is two elevators in the lobby.
19. Each of the campers bring a flashlight.

20. The instructions printed on the box was confusing.

Answer Key

Part A: Parts of Speech

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| 1. preposition | 11. adjective |
| 2. adverb | 12. pronoun |
| 3. noun | 13. noun |
| 4. adjective | 14. verb |
| 5. conjunction | 15. adverb |
| 6. pronoun | 16. preposition |
| 7. verb | 17. conjunction |
| 8. adverb | 18. adjective |
| 9. preposition | 19. pronoun |
| 10. conjunction | 20. verb |

Part B: Subject and Predicate

CS = complete subject, CP = complete predicate, SS = simple subject, SP = simple predicate.

- CS: The exhausted swimmer CP: floated on her back SS: swimmer SP: floated
- CS: Jonah and Priya CP: shared a locker all year SS: Jonah, Priya (compound) SP: shared
- CS: an empty trash can CP: Down the driveway rolled SS: can SP: rolled (inverted order)
- CS: The steady hum of the refrigerator CP: annoyed everyone SS: hum SP: annoyed
- CS: My brother's sprained wrist CP: ached for weeks SS: wrist SP: ached
- CS: The careful electrician CP: tested every outlet SS: electrician SP: tested
- CS: a broken lawnmower CP: Behind the garage sat SS: lawnmower SP: sat (inverted order)
- CS: The referee CP: paused the game and checked the clock SS: referee SP: paused, checked (compound)
- CS: The radio and the newspaper CP: reported the same story SS: radio, newspaper (compound) SP: reported
- CS: A tall, quiet exchange student CP: joined our class SS: student SP: joined
- CS: a stray kitten CP: Under the porch hid SS: kitten SP: hid (inverted order)

12. CS: The retired pilot CP: trusted her own instincts SS: pilot SP: trusted
13. CS: Ines CP: packed her lunch and caught the early bus SS: Ines SP: packed, caught (compound)
14. CS: The smell of fresh bread CP: filled the hallway SS: smell SP: filled
15. CS: My grandfather's four acres of orchard CP: needed constant care SS: acres SP: needed

Part C: Subject–Verb Agreement

- | | |
|------------|------------|
| 1. sits | 9. host |
| 2. was | 10. show |
| 3. walk | 11. knows |
| 4. knows | 12. seems |
| 5. are | 13. come |
| 6. worries | 14. tastes |
| 7. blocks | 15. make |
| 8. need | |

Notes: 1, 6, 7, 10, and 14 turn on the true subject (*carton, news, row, scratches, most* = most of the milk), not the noun nearest the verb. In 4 and 9, “neither/nor” and “either/or” agree with the *nearer* subject. In 5 and 13 the subject follows the verb (*exits, runners*). In 12, *nine dollars* is a single amount, so it takes a singular verb.

Rewrites:

16. The stack of towels **was** still damp.
17. Neither Ravi nor Celia **remembers** the address.
18. There **are** two elevators in the lobby.
19. Each of the campers **brings** a flashlight.
20. The instructions printed on the box **were** confusing.